

CHOWON KANG

Industrial Design Engineering Major | KAIST Scholar

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SKILLS

- **Research Skills:** Qualitative/Quantitative Research Methods, UserTesting, Data analysis(Python, SPSS)
- **Design Tools:** Figma, Adobe Tools, Auto CAD, Rhinoceros 3D, Sketchup Pro, V-ray
- **Language:** English – Native (IBT TOEFL: 115, OPIC: AL), Korean – Native

PUBLICATIONS

Beyond Swipes and Scores: Investigating Practices, Challenges and User-Centered Values in Online

Dating Algorithms

Minor Revision for CSCW2024

- **Authors: Chowon Kang**, Yoonseo Choi, Yongjae Sohn, Hyunseung Lim, Hwajung Hong
- Identified challenges and desires associated with South Korean online dating application users and proposed algorithmic features aimed at promoting diverse contextual user values, optimizing matchmaking features depending on partners, and supporting personal growth in romantic relationships.

Korean Emoticons: Understanding How Subtle Emotional Differences Are Evoked Online

CSCW2022

- **Authors: Chowon Kang**, Jong-Ok Hong, Wooje Chang, Hyeon-Jeong Suk, Hwajung Hong
- Defined subtle emotional differences of Korean Emoticons ‘ㄷ, ㅎ, ㅠ’ depending on the numbers and context combination of emoticons through quantitative & qualitative data analysis of surveys & interviews

EXPERIENCES

Identifying Algorithmic Features for Online Dating Applications (Master's Thesis)

Sep 2021 – Sep 2023

- Conducted 22 interviews, 3 user tests, and 5 groups of user participatory design workshops to derive design implications and algorithmic features that fulfil the needs of romantic relationships in online dating

UX Researcher at Ridi Books

April 2024 - Present

UX Researcher at Class101 (Internship)

Feb 2024 – March 2024

- Plan surveys to explore the opportunities of a reward system to increase user engagement and retention rates within the subscription model of Class101

Wanwol-dong Red District Alley Regeneration (Busan State Competition, Grand Prize)

Aug 2020 – Sep 2020

- Conduct context analysis, ethnography and interviews to propose regeneration planning and policies by focusing on occupational rehabilitation of women who excised prostitution and influx of external capital

Renovate and Build Homes for the Elderly and Poor (Habitat for Humanity)

Mar 2018 – Mar 2020

Architecture Designer at Simplex Architecture (Internship)

Aug 2019 – Sep 2019

EDUCATION

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology, Major Industrial Design (MSc)

Grad: Feb 2024

- Master's student at DxD lab, under Dr Hwajung Hong
- **Courses:** User Centered Design Methodology, Research Methodology, Data Analytics for Designers, Managing Design Innovation for Business / Technology / Society, Computational Design

Technical University of Delft, Major Design for Interaction (Exchange student)

Sep 2022 – Feb 2023

Hongik University, Major Interior Architecture (BAsC)

Grad: Feb 2021

- **Multiple scholarships, including:** Creation(2020, 2018)(GPA 97.6%), Cooperative(2019, 2018)(94.7%)

Pusan Foreign Language High School (French)

Grad: Feb 2015

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- **Information Design** (Instructor: Hwajung Hong, KAIST): Undergraduate course for data visualization; Teach basic Illustration; Feedback and support for brainstorming and ideation
- **Introduction to Design** (Instructor: Eunkyong Baek, KAIST): Feedback for group projects; QnA sessions